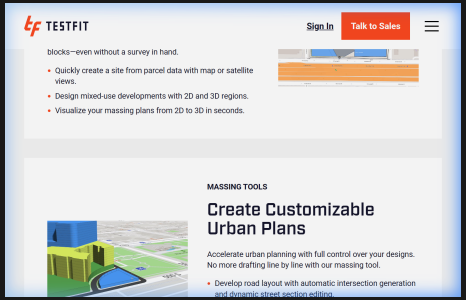
TestFit, Real Estate Feasibility, and the Changing Politics of Site Planning

AI and City Building

Daniel Hardesty Lewis · PLAN A6613 · April 7, 2026

What TestFit Claims to Do



Source: testfit.io/product/site-solver

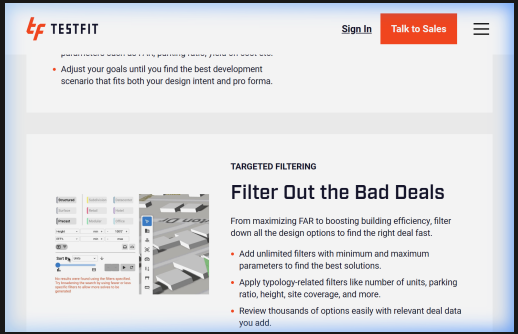
- ▷ A **real estate feasibility platform** for early-stage site planning
- ▷ Generates building layouts under zoning, parking, and financial constraints in seconds
- ▷ Integrates with Revit and AutoCAD for downstream design

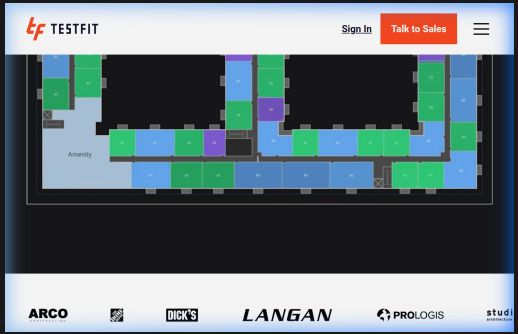
Vendor framing (testfit.io):

"Win Profitable Deals."

Note the language: the unit of analysis is a **deal**, not a building or a neighborhood.

Design Through Financial and Regulatory Parameters





Deal filter interface: FAR, height, efficiency, parking ratio

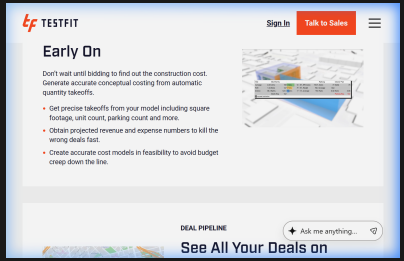
Source: testfit.io/product/deal-evaluation

Algorithmically generated unit layout

Source: testfit.io/product/site-solver

Users adjust yield, FAR, and parking constraints; the algorithm generates the physical form.

Included and Excluded Values



Metrics: acreage, FAR, units, efficiency, height, parking stalls, ratio

Source: testfit.io/product/deal-evaluation

Representable in the software:

- ✓ Unit count, FAR, building efficiency
- ✓ Parking ratio, site coverage
- ✓ Pro forma revenue and cost estimates
- ✓ Zoning envelope compliance

Not primary optimization targets:

- × Contextual design considerations
- × Displacement risk or affordability
- × Community preferences or political feasibility
- × Environmental or public health impacts

The question is not whether optimization is useful, but which values get encoded and whose objectives the optimization serves.

Who Has Access?

Developers iterate numerous compliant layouts before a hearing. Reviewing agencies evaluate one submission at a time.

Asymmetric modeling capacity can shift bargaining power.

When feasibility is evaluated through proprietary, high-speed optimization, which values become easier to represent, and which values become harder to defend?

Daniel Hardesty Lewis

PLAN A6613: AI and the Future of Cities

Product documentation: testfit.io